



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 3

ARKANSAS

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Arkansas's family courts and child-welfare system.

42

ARKANSAS FAMILIES ON RECORD · 61
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 24 MONTHS
MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING
TIME

REPORT GENERATED

MAY 9, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED

14 OF 75

COMPILED BY

MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

ARKANSAS AT A GLANCE.

Across 42 Arkansas families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 61 42 of 42 families reported child counts	MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN \$162,000 median across 18 families reporting 3+ categories	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 24 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 45.2% 28.6% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 42	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.5	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 42 of 42	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 14

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Arkansas families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

02 THE COST OF ARKANSAS FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	27	\$12,000	\$68,520	\$1,850,050
Lost Wages	22	\$35,000	\$287,727	\$6,330,000
Other Court Fees	14	\$2,250	\$23,570	\$329,980
Therapy / Evaluations	19	\$3,000	\$8,563	\$162,700
Reunification Services	15	\$0	\$1,353	\$20,300
GAL Fees	22	\$1,600	\$17,161	\$377,550
Asset Loss ¹	18	\$50,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (18 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	\$162,000	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least \$1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$50,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		24	2 yrs
Mean months lost		34	2.8 yrs
Total across all families		1,019	84.9 yrs

03 WHO IS REPORTING · ARKANSAS

Most families documenting in Arkansas are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed		17	40%
Not provided		9	21%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		8	19%
Case closed: within last 2 years		7	17%
Active case: progress being made		1	2%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS		23	55%
Family Court Only		11	26%
CPS (Child Protective Services) Only		4	10%
Unknown		4	10%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		17	40%
5 – 10 years		8	19%
3 – 5 years		6	14%
Over 10 years		4	10%
5+ years		3	7%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access		13	31%
Visitation Only		12	29%
Adopted Out (Rights Terminated)		7	17%
50/50 Joint		4	10%
Full Custody		4	10%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Sebastian		4	10%
Boone		4	10%
Lonoke		4	10%
White		3	7%
Greene		2	5%
Pulaski		2	5%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		19	45%
Other: (Short answer)		7	17%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		6	14%
Other		3	7%
High Conflict Divorce		2	5%

04 PARENT VOICES — ARKANSAS

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Arkansas comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.



Wmy kids survived being abused for 12 years I am still unable to keep employment cause child support enforcement keeps my driver's licence

— HAMONN

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

Arkansas allows parental kidnappings across state lines and dropping children off with open alcohol bottles in the car and is giving parents with past DUIs full custody and parents with clean records no due process.

— ARKANSAS PARENT · ANONYMOUS

MORE VOICES FROM ARKANSAS

Dhs-dcfs, child litem, casa fosters family court judge and attorneys

— ANTONIA

Violated my constitutional rights, system is a scam and doesn't care about the children

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They gave my baby ro a drunk and a man who killed himself because he was messing with kids and he was gay

— LAURA

Ripped us apart, erased the God given fact that I gave birth to my son, utterly and completely destroyed the relationship between my only child and I. Made me out to be so.e ki d of criminal, crazy drug addict who was incapable of caring for her son.

— ANGELA

American Family Court Genocide Has Killed My Family. American Veterans Children Matter!!

— AUBREY

Instead of protecting our family and those at risk, DCFS and the juvenile justice system has fractured our family. The trauma experienced doesn't just impact us but it will impact my nieces and their children and their children's children.

— TAMARA

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



My children were removed from my care by the Arkansas Division of Family Services under circumstances that were both unfair and deeply distressing. For over a year, the agency made it nearly impossible for me to regain custody, despite my constant efforts to comply with every [...]

— CHARISSA

Severe mental trauma PTSD depression

— KEVIN

Bankrupted us we lost our home, boats, vehicles sanity and caused grievance fir lost time with our grand children

— BRENDA

This system originally made it to where I was only allowed to see my children every other weekend and on Tuesdays, giving the mother full control to manipulate the minds of my kids. The state changed from this to 50/50 custody as a standard during the 2nd filing for visitation [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They took a loving parent and gave them to an abusive parent.

— NICKI

This is an America Family Genocide System!

— AUBREY

American Family Court Genocide Matters. Arkansas Hates Family And Has Destroyed Mine And Tried To Kill Us. I am a combat veteran..this family Court war....is worse than war in the Middle East.

— AUBREY

Him and the court has caused confusion with my children. Being alienated because your ex is beyond disgruntled and obsessed with destroying myself and my kids self esteem, security, and bond with their mother.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Lied under oath, broke my son's arm under care and still was able to adopt him, sent cruel messages and told me to sign my rights away

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



They have failed my son in every way possible including protecting him they removed based on false allegations and my other children miss their brother we want him located his safety verified and home where he is loved wanted missed and safe! I have everything ready and I'm so [...]

— AMY

I have four children in which one of my children is autistic level three nonverbal. He has not seen me in five months. I have not slept a good night sleep in over six months. I sleep for maybe two hours and I'm up for 22.

— BRITTANY

Due process violations, lost time with my kids , and being forced to spend money I don't have or be separated from my kids, along with being treated as a disposable parent are the inherent issues I have faced.

— MARVIN

It has tried to destroy me by its lies and what I believe to be illegal actions. It robbed my son and I from every milestone a teenager has. Mostly it has robbed us of our life. It has taken everything from the smallest Saturday morning hair, laughter, stories, experiences just [...]

— SANDRA

Lonoke Judge Parker should be reported and all his cases looked at by the law board. The whole court system in Lonoke County is ripping great loving mothers from their children and allowing men to do anything they wish and make it a court order. How does he sleep at night.. on [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has torn my family apart my son's father has passed since this beginning of this and he didn't even get to grieve during this difficult time of losing his dad which was his world

— STACEY

I have lost everything.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I dropped my kids off at school and they never got off the bus. I was met outside my home with handcuffs to be taken to interrogation room. My youngest had no mental health problems and now she deals with severe separation anxiety from me. My oldest struggles to fight the [...]

— JENESSA

The court ignored my daughter's statements of sexual abuse and awarded custody to her abuser. She has since experienced SI. The court refused to acknowledge violations of court order.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

04 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED

Disregarded the laws and opened my eyes to realize the laws are seemingly made for civilians and not for government officials to follow. OR Do as I say, not as I do. They are judge and jury in a no jury, unlawful, overpowered bias system.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I've been being sued my Dad/Stepmok since 2018-2026 for full custody of my two daughters he got temporary custody of them and has had that now for 13 months

— CHRISTINE

It didn't listen to me when I said he'll move far away and then take the girls. That he'll just keep coming at me until they are 18 when he can't make money off of them

— JESSICA

It has been very insane the amount of families that are put through this that don't deserve it. They didn't give me a chance from the beginning offered no help but speedy court dates.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

30 Arkansas parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 30 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — ARKANSAS

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Arkansas families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

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— TAMARA

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My children were removed from my care by the Arkansas Division of Family Services under circumstances that were both unfair and deeply distressing. For over a year, the agency made it nearly impossible for me to regain custody, despite my constant efforts to comply with every requirement and reunite with my children. When my children were taken, I immediately asked that they be placed with family members, but that request was refused. The department delayed setting up the counseling and support services that I was ordered to complete, even though I was ready and willing to participate. To make matters worse, they moved my children four hours away from me, knowing that I did not have a vehicle. This made it almost impossible to visit them regularly, no matter how much I wanted to. Throughout the process, I was portrayed inaccurately. In court, the department told the judge that I was not trying or cooperating, which was completely untrue. The Arkansas State Police later investigated the allegations that led to my children's removal and found them to be unfounded and untrue. Even with that finding, my children were never returned to my care. Eventually, I was pressured into signing away my parental rights — not because I wanted to, but because I was cornered and made to feel that I had no other choice. My children were adopted, and I live every day with the pain of knowing that the truth was ignored and that I did everything I could to bring them home. This experience has left me determined to speak up — for myself, for my children, and for other parents who are struggling to be heard and treated fairly.

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Severe mental trauma PTSD depression

— KEVIN

Bankrupted us we lost our home, boats, vehicles sanity and caused grievance fir lost time with our grand children

— BRENDA

05 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This system originally made it to where I was only allowed to see my children every other weekend and on Tuesdays, giving the mother full control to manipulate the minds of my kids. The state changed from this to 50/50 custody as a standard during the 2nd filing for visitation with my children. Because I have been successful at my job and constantly pushing to do better for my kids, I was told even with this agreement I have to shoulder the burden of child support, insurance, and the mother gets to choose which school the children attend. To this day my children have said they would rather attend schools closer to me and hate that the mother and her family have continued to talk negatively about me. The court has made it almost impossible to hold her accountable and she uses this knowledge to continue to cause issues in my new marriage and relationship with the children. Decisions about custody were made because she had a majority of the custody time and the fact that my children were stripped from me during Christmas and held for 6 months was never factored into this. It was like it didn't matter. Watching the pain in my youngest child's face when it's the night before they return is horrible. I have fought for the betterment of my children and constantly told that because I'm the dad, the burden of proof is higher on me that she is doing wrong.

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30 full approved Arkansas comments are included in this appendix.

06 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Arkansas report comes from Arkansas respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Arkansas — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 42 Arkansas families reporting here are not the universe of Arkansas families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – May 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte-Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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